produced by direct “touch”). I can still remember—or at least believe I can remember—that this experience made a deep and lasting impression upon me.

Something deeply hidden had to be behind things.

It seems to me that this impulse lies at the heart of all of Einstein’s worries about quantum mechanics. He might have fretted out loud about indeterminism and nonlocality, but what really bugged him was his sense that Copenhagen quantum mechanics replaced the crisp rigor of good scientific theories with a fuzzy paradigm in which an ill-defined notion of “measurement” played a central role. He was always on the lookout for the deeply hidden thing beneath the surface, the principle that would restore intelligibility to that which had drifted into mystery. Little did he suspect that what was hidden might be other branches of the wave function.

It doesn’t really matter what Einstein would have actually thought, of course; scientific theories rise or fall on their merits, not because we can conjure up hypothetical ghosts of great minds from the past to nod their approval.

But it’s useful to pay attention to those great minds, if only to be reminded of the connections between debates of the past and research in the present. The issues discussed in this book stem directly from the discussions between Einstein and Bohr and others in the 1920s. In the wake of the Solvay Conference, popular opinion within the physics community swung Bohr’s way, and the Copenhagen approach to quantum mechanics settled in as entrenched dogma. It’s proven to be an amazingly successful tool at making predictions for experiments and designing new technologies. But as a fundamental theory of the world, it falls woefully short.

I’ve laid out the case for why Many-Worlds is the most promising formulation of quantum mechanics. But I have enormous respect for, and have frequent productive conversations with, partisans for other approaches. What makes me melancholy are professional physicists who dismiss foundational work and don’t think the issues are worth taking seriously. After reading this book, whether or not you would describe yourself as an Everettian, I hope you are convinced of the importance of getting quantum mechanics right once and for all.

I’m optimistic about how things are progressing. The modern study of quantum foundations isn’t just a bunch of elderly physicists chatting about fantastical ideas over tumblers of scotch after the real work is done for the day. Much of the recent progress in developing our understanding of